



MAKING A REPLICA OF A DINOSAUR

There are different methods of making a replica of a dinosaur's fossilized skeleton. One way is to make a mold of each fossilized bone and use these molds to make a cast.



▲ STEP 1 The fossil is first pressed halfway into a clay base, and liquid rubber (shown in blue) is painted over both the fossil and the base. This will set to form a flexible coat.



▲ STEP 2 Once dry, the rubber is covered with fiberglass sheets. The sheets make the rubber mold rigid enough to keep its shape when it is removed.



▲ STEP 3 Once set, the outer mold is removed. Now a second mold is made in the same way of the other side of the fossil.



▲ STEP 4 The two molds are joined and held together.



▲ STEP 5 The complete mold is filled with liquid polyester or some other lightweight material. This will form a cast.



▲ STEP 6 Finally, the mold can be opened gently. If the technicians have been careful, a perfect cast is revealed.



▲ A welder joins every part of the Barosaurus to the metal frame inserted in its skeleton.



▲ The final stage is to join Barosaurus's upper neck and head to its lower neck.

